

**Swiggy delivery challenge**

The inside details on how Swiggy calculates an accurate delivery time for your food orders. <https://dgit.in/aug20-43>

**Diversification of startups**

Some startups are seeing an opportunity during the pandemic, and introducing new services. <https://dgit.in/aug20-44>

Delivering the essentials

With the mounting demand for doorstep delivery of groceries and other essentials, startups begin entering this lucrative sector

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midst the atypical lifestyle we are living today, where home quarantining and lockdown have

become the norm, the need for essential delivery services has skyrocketed.

While investments in the Indian tech arena suffered on the whole during the past few months, a majority of deals surrounded startups that catered to essential services. According to Technavio, online on-demand food delivery services are poised to grow by USD 104.45 billion during 2019-2023, growing at a CAGR of over 15 per cent.

Food delivery startups such as Big Basket and Grofers witnessed a whopping 80-100 per cent spike in orders during the lockdown period. There is, no doubt, a dire need for essential items delivery services. Numerous startups are recognising the opportunity in this field and entering it to capitalise on the burgeoning demand, while few are adjusting their business models to cater to this growing sector.

THE ESSENTIAL DELIVERY STARTUPS BOOM

Due to increased demand and reduced staff, existing e-grocers went through a business process restructuring to increase their productivity and meet the demand. Not just Grofers and Big Basket, startups such as Nandu's

Chicken, Licious, iD Fresh Foods and others have also started partnering up with delivery services such as Swiggy, Zomato, and Dunzo in order to deliver all the orders. Currently, Big Basket fulfils a whopping 283,000 orders per day as compared to 150,000 before the lockdown, while Grofers services about 190,000 daily orders against 100,000 before the shutdown.

As per a news report in the Hindu Businessline, Licious, a startup delivering fresh meat and seafood, saw a 30 per cent surge in demand across the seven cities it operates in. To combat this, the startup not only partnered up with delivery service providers to get more drivers to fulfil orders, but also stopped their express delivery service (within 90 minutes) and adopted a slotted delivery model.



Big Basket and Grofers saw a massive surge in demand during the lockdown

Existing brands such as iD Fresh Food, began launching new features and technologies to ease the delivery process and to enable people to find relevant essential items. iD Fresh Food launched a 'Store Finder' feature to let



iD Fresh Food started a 'Store Finder' feature during the lockdown to make it easier to order from the shop closest to home

people know when certain products they sold were available in stores close to their home. They even added a 'notify me' feature that pinged customers when they item they were looking for came back in stock.

In addition to e-grocers, online pharmacies such as Medlife, 1mg and PharmEasy also saw a massive surge in their business during the pandemic. These startups began providing contact-less home deliveries of medicines and medical equipment and some also began providing online medical